

PV Internship

Task 5

Individual Case Safety Report (ICSR)

Perform a complete pharmacovigilance assessment on a detailed case study. This includes ADR identification, reporting, causality assessment, and severity classification, simulating the role of a Drug Safety Associate.

SOURCE

Lisinopril-associated bullous pemphigoid in an elderly woman: a case report of a rare adverse drug reaction <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6177705/>

ADR Identification

Parameter	Information
Suspected medicine	Lisinopril
ADR	Drug-induced bullous pemphigoid
Main manifestations	Severely itchy, eroded/scaly vesicular skin lesions
Initial location	Trunk
Progression	Lower back → thighs → shoulders → upper/lower limbs
Time to onset	Approximately 2 months after lisinopril dose escalation
Previous dose	20 mg/day
Increased dose	40 mg/day
Dechallenge	Positive — lesions began resolving after discontinuation
Rechallenge	Not reported
Outcome	Most lesions completely healed without scarring

ICSR Data

Patient Information

Field	Information
Age	87 years
Sex	Female
Weight	82 kg
Patient initials	Not reported
Medical history	Hypertension, hypothyroidism, type 2 diabetes
Previous ADRs	None reported
Allergies	No history of allergies reported

Investigations including CBC, electrolytes, liver enzymes, TSH and ESR were normal. Skin biopsy and direct immunofluorescence supported a diagnosis of **drug-induced bullous pemphigoid (BP)**.

Causality Assessment — Naranjo Scale

Question	Assessment	Score
1. Previous conclusive reports?	Yes	+1
2. ADR occurred after suspected drug?	Yes	+2
3. Improved after discontinuation?	Yes	+1
4. Reappeared after re-administration?	Not reported	0
5. Alternative causes?	No	+2
6. Reaction with placebo?	Not reported	0
7. Toxic drug concentration?	Not reported	0
8. Dose-response relationship?	Yes	+1
9. Previous similar reaction?	Not reported	0
10. Objective evidence?	Yes	+1

Naranjo ADR Probability Score reported: 7 — Probable.

Parameter	Classification
Severity	Severe, Extensive severely itchy skin lesions
Seriousness	Not clearly established
Expectedness	Unexpected, Bullous pemphigoid was not listed among the relevant adverse reactions
Outcome	Recovered, as it improved after discontinuation of Lisinopril.

The case was assessed as a suspected lisinopril-associated ADR with a probable causal relationship. This demonstrates the role of a Drug Safety Associate in identifying, documenting, evaluating and classifying adverse drug reactions.